

LIVING LIFE WITH AN ATTITUDE

* Blue denotes PPT slide

* Brown denotes instructions to technician

INTRO: The setting of the sixth chapter of 2 Chronicles is as follows:

- Solomon had built a house for God...
- The construction of the Temple had been completed...
- The Temple had been furnished according to the instructions of the Lord through Moses...
- The people had gathered for the dedication of this historic structure...
- Solomon spoke to the people outlining how the building had come about... (***You have spoken with your mouth and performed it with your hand***)
- Solomon reminded God of His promises to His people and staked a claim for those promises...

In verse nineteen Solomon seems to shift gears and begins asking God to be very purposeful concerning the prayers of the people. His

request to God was for the prayers of the people to be answered if they met two requirements:

- Pray in or toward the Temple... (We are the Temple of the Holy Ghost)
- Repentance on the part of the people...

Solomon then laid out what He wanted Gods attitude, but more importantly the attitude of the people to be, concerning the prayers of the people with regard to the human condition.

It is my belief that the prayer of Solomon should be the attitude of the church. We must remember that the attitude with which we approach life and approach people, will make an impact upon the lives of those who have never been born again, and those who have broken fellowship with God and/or the church.

Our church, and our vision should mirror the attitude of Solomon, the people, and God in this passage. **The vision of CT Church is to: (PLACE ON SCREEN ONE AT A TIME AND LEAVE ON SCREEN UNTIL NEXT SLIDE)**

- **Disciple...** (The Great Commission is not to make converts, it is to make disciples – We have not made a disciple until we have

reached an individual – Mentored them –
They have reached an individual – Our
disciple is mentoring their disciple)

- **Empower...** (Empower through – Training, resourcing and the power of the Holy Spirit)
- **Serve...** (No one can find true fulfillment in life without serving vertically and horizontally)

During the course of this series I am hopeful we can get focused on approaching life and people with the same attitude that I hear loud and clear in the prayer of Solomon.

ATTITUDE # 1 FORGIVENESS

2 Chronicles 6:21 (NKJV) ***“May You hear the supplications of Your servant and of Your people Israel, when they pray toward this place. Hear from heaven Your dwelling place, and when You hear, forgive.”***

Solomon’s request was that God and the people would be quick to forgive sinners and that the Temple attitude would be one of forgiveness.

Certainly, this is God’s attitude and should be the attitude of the church. When people come to

Christ we must forgive them and assist them in forgiving themselves. Psalm 103:12 (NKJV) ***“As far as the east is from the west, So far has He removed our transgressions from us.”***

May this be a house with an attitude of forgiveness!

LIFE GROUP DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

READ 2 CHRONICLES 6

- 1) WHAT WAS SOLOMONS GREATEST ACHEIVEMENT? (Building the Temple)
- 2) WHAT TWO THINGS WERE MENTIONED THAT CAUSED THE VISION OF SOLOMON TO BUILD A TEMPLE TO COME TO PASS? (What they said with their mouths were performed with their hands – We can talk a big game but until we begin performing the task with our hands, nothing is going to happen – We are waiting on God and he is waiting on us – We can talk all we want to about our concern for people but until we attempt to get them to connect with our life groups it is just talk)
- 3) WHAT TWO THINGS ARE NECESSARY

FOR ONE TO MAKE THINGS RIGHT
WITH GOD? (Prayer and repentance)

- 4) WHAT IS THE CT VISION? (Disciple – Empower – Serve – Discuss this and how the vision can be incorporated into the life group – Come up with a written plan and keep the people reminded of the plan each time you have your life group)
- 5) WHAT WAS THE FIRST ATTITUDE SOLOMON PRAYED FOR THE PEOPLE TO EMBRACE? (Forgiveness – Read 2 Chronicles 6:21)
- 6) IN SOLOMONS PRAYER WHO WAS MANDATED TO OFFER FORGIVENESS? (The People and the church)
- 7) WHO SHOULD WE FORGIVE? (Others and ourselves – Self forgiveness is very important)
- 8) HOW COMPLETELY HAS GOD FORGIVEN US? (Read Psalm 103:12 – God has completely forgiven us and we must completely forgive ourselves and others)

ATTITUDE #2 MERCY

2 Chronicles 6:22-23 (NKJV) ***“If anyone sins against his neighbor, and is forced to take an oath, and comes and takes an oath before Your altar in this temple, 23 then hear from heaven, and act, and judge Your servants, bringing retribution on the wicked by bringing his way on his own head, and justifying the righteous by giving him according to his righteousness.”***

Solomon is saying, let this be a house with an attitude of mercy!

- If someone has taken an oath they cannot live up to... Let this be a house of mercy!
- If anyone sins against his neighbor... Let this be a house of mercy!
- If anyone misses the mark... Let this be a house of mercy!
- In retribution... Let this be a house of mercy!

We are ok with having God's mercy meter reset in our lives every day but I am wondering how willing we are to push the reset button for others?

In the Old Testament a manslayer could run to

the house of God and hold onto the horns of the altar, and as long as he was in that posture he was covered in mercy!

If we are going to reach people this must be a house of mercy!

May this be a house with an attitude of mercy!

ATTITUDE #3 RESTORATION

2 Chronicles 6:24-25 (NKJV) ***"If Your people Israel are defeated before an enemy because they have sinned against You, and return and confess Your name, and pray and make supplication before You in this temple, 25 then hear from heaven and forgive the sin of Your people Israel, and bring them back to the land which You gave to them and their fathers."***

Solomon is asking God to cause the Temple to always have an attitude of restoration. He wanted the Temple default to be restoration.

It is one thing to have mercy and forgive; it is another matter to dirty our hands in the process

of restoration! Restoration is both an attitude and an activity.

Solomon said:

- When they sin... Restore them!
- When they are defeated... Restore them!
- When they are taken captive... Restore them!
- When they cry out to you... Restore them!

Listen to these beautiful words, ***"...hear from heaven and forgive the sin of Your people Israel, and bring them back to the land which You gave to them and their fathers."***

The constant state of God's activity is rescue and restoration!

There are those out there who have sinned against God, you, and this church. If we are going to reach them we must start here and now to be people of restoration who build a house of restoration!

Let me ask you a question for you to answer mentally. What is the name of the person that if they come to, or back to this church, would

make you quit the church?

Don't forget... ***"All have sinned and come short of the glory of God."***

May this be a house with an attitude of restoration!

LIFE GROUP DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

READ 2 CHRONICLES CHAPTER 6

- 1) WHAT WAS THE SECOND ATTITUDE SOLOMON PRAYED FOR THE PEOPLE AND THE CHURCH TO EMBRACE?
(Mercy – Read 2 Chronicles 6:22-23)
- 2) WE WANT AND EVEN EXPECT MERCY BUT HOW WILLING ARE WE TO GRANT MERCY? (Read the words of Jesus from Matthew 5:7)
- 3) WHAT SHOULD BE OUR PERSONAL DEFAULT AND THE DEFAULT OF THE CHURCH? (Restoration – Restoration is an attitude and an activity)
- 4) IS THERE ANYONE WHO HAS WALKED OUT OF YOUR LIFE THAT IF THEY WALK BACK IN YOU CANNOT EMBRACE THEM? (If so, you need to forgive them and

prepare to be a restorer to them – Lead the group in prayer for such things to be corrected)

ATTITUDE #4 HARVEST AND PROSPERITY

2 Chronicles 6:26-27 (NKJV) *"When the heavens are shut up and there is no rain because they have sinned against You, when they pray toward this place and confess Your name, and turn from their sin because You afflict them, 27 then hear in heaven, and forgive the sin of Your servants, Your people Israel, that You may teach them the good way in which they should walk; and send rain on Your land which You have given to Your people as an inheritance."*

Solomon recognized that the result of the sins of the people manifests itself by dragging them down into an impoverished condition. In spite of this, he asked God, when the people pray in or toward the Temple that the house of the Lord would produce harvest and eventually prosperity! He wanted the Temple to be the one place that had an attitude of harvest and prosperity!

- When they sin against you... Turn them toward the house of harvest and prosperity!
- When the Heavens are shut up... Turn them toward the house of harvest and prosperity!
- When they are impoverished... Turn them toward the house of harvest and prosperity!
- When they have no food... Turn them toward the house of harvest and prosperity!

Do you know anyone who is broke, busted, and disgusted? Bring them to this house of harvest and prosperity!

I believe the promise made in Malachi of such blessing that ***“There shall not be room enough to receive it”*** is a corporate blessing to the church who walks in lockstep to a vision with each person doing his/her part... Including and especially tithing!

May this be a house of harvest and prosperity!

ATTITUDE #5 PROTECTION

2 Chronicles 6:28-30 (NKJV) ***“When there is famine in the land, pestilence or blight or mildew, locusts or grasshoppers; when their***

enemies besiege them in the land of their cities; whatever plague or whatever sickness there is; 29 whatever prayer, whatever supplication is made by anyone, or by all Your people Israel, when each one knows his own burden and his own grief, and spreads out his hands to this temple: 30 then hear from heaven Your dwelling place, and forgive, and give to everyone according to all his ways, whose heart You know (for You alone know the hearts of the sons of men).

Solomon prayed that the Temple would be a place that had an attitude of protection.

- When there is famine in the land... May the Temple be a safe zone!
- When the people are overwhelmed by sickness... May the Temple be a safe zone!
- When plagues overrun the land... May the Temple be a safe zone!
- When there is terror on every side... May the Temple be a safe zone!

Listen to the words of David as he was fleeing

from Absalom. Psalm 3:1-8 (NKJV) ***“Lord, how they have increased who trouble me! Many are they who rise up against me. 2 Many are they who say of me, “There is no help for him in God.” Selah 3 But You, O Lord, are a shield for me, My glory and the One who lifts up my head. 4 I cried to the Lord with my voice, And He heard me from His holy hill. Selah 5 I lay down and slept; I awoke, for the Lord sustained me. 6 I will not be afraid of ten thousands of people Who have set themselves against me all around. 7 Arise, O Lord; Save me, O my God! For You have struck all my enemies on the cheekbone; You have broken the teeth of the ungodly. 8 Salvation belongs to the Lord. Your blessing is upon Your people. Selah”***

Isaiah 54:17 (NKJV) ***“No weapon formed against you shall prosper, And every tongue which rises against you in judgment You shall condemn. This is the heritage of the servants of the Lord, And their***

righteousness is from Me," Says the Lord."

May this be a house with an attitude of protection! A place where people know they have entered a safe zone! A place where we have each other's backs!

LIFE GROUP DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

READ 2 CHRONICLES 6

- 1) WHAT WAS SOLOMONS FOURTH ATTITUDE REQUEST? (Harvest and Prosperity – Read 2 Chronicles 6:26-27)
- 2) WHY DID SOLOMON PRAY FOR HARVEST AND PROSPERITY? (Because he recognized that the sinfulness of the people had robbed them of the blessing of the Lord – This is always the case – Read Proverbs 14:34)
- 3) WHAT WAS SOLOMONS FIFTH ATTITUDE REQUEST? (Protection – Read 2 Chronicles 6:28-30)
- 4) WHAT KIND OF SAFE ZONES SHOULD WE BE CREATING? (The Church should always be a safe zone – The life group should be a safe zone – How can we facilitate such an environment?)

ATTITUDE # 6 EQUALITY AND DIVERSITY

2 Chronicles 6:32-33 (NKJV) ***“Moreover, concerning a foreigner, who is not of Your people Israel, but has come from a far country for the sake of Your great name and Your mighty hand and Your outstretched arm, when they come and pray in this temple; 33 then hear from heaven Your dwelling place, and do according to all for which the foreigner calls to You, that all peoples of the earth may know Your name and fear You, as do Your people Israel, and that they may know that this temple which I have built is called***

by Your name."

Solomon prayed that the Temple would be a place with an attitude of equality and diversity!

Are you ready for this? God's house should be built on level ground for the black, white, red, yellow and the purple with pink polka dots! The ground should be level for the rich and the poor; for the have's and have not's; for the up and outers and the down and outers!

The Church should be a place of equality and diversity! I am not speaking of diversity in the same way the warped world views it.

I am speaking of diversity so that everyone's talents and gifts may be celebrated! People go where they are celebrated, not where they are tolerated!

I know for a fact that people have left this church because it has become to ethnically diverse for them. People who leave for that reason always point to something else so as not to tip their hand to their bigoted views! I am not trying to be unkind but this must be a church with an attitude of diversity and equality!

What race of people would run you off your pew or out of this church? Can you look them in the eyes and tell them, God loves them but you don't want to sit by them? Can you tell them God wants to redeem them eternally but you don't want to go to church with them?

Some of the largest missions giving churches in America are churches with extreme racial barriers. People often give their money to help their conscience outrun the guilt of their bigoted attitudes! Discrimination is a sin!

Listen to how we are recognized AFTER we receive our glorified bodies. [Revelation 7:9](#) (NKJV) ***"After these things I looked, and behold, a great multitude which no one could number, of all nations, tribes, peoples, and tongues, standing before the throne and before the Lamb, clothed with white robes, with palm branches in their hands."***

If we are going to be a church with an attitude of diversity and equality:

- The poor and the rich will sit together...

- Blacks and whites will sit together...
- Hispanics and Asians will sit together...
- Christians and non-Christians will sit together...
- Gays and straights will sit together...

If we are going to reach people we must come to the place where we have an attitude of diversity and equality. What does that look like? Being able to hate sin while loving the sinner.

May this be a church with an attitude of equality and diversity!

ATTITUDE # 7 VICTORY

2 Chronicles 6:34-35 (NKJV) ***“When Your people go out to battle against their enemies, wherever You send them, and when they pray to You toward this city which You have chosen and the temple which I have built for Your name, 35 then hear from heaven their prayer and their supplication, and maintain their cause.”***

Solomon is requesting that God would cause the Temple to exemplify an attitude of victory.

- When they go to battle... May they have an attitude of victory!
- When they stand before their enemies... May they have an attitude of victory!
- When you send them out... May they have an attitude of victory!
- When you bring them in... May they have an attitude of victory!
- When they pray toward this place... May you give them victory!

Listen to this, [2 Chronicles 6:35](#) “... ***hear from heaven their prayer and their supplication, and maintain their cause.***” The word maintain here is ‘asah (aw-saw) meaning to do or to make. Solomon is praying that when the people have repented and petitioned the Lord that He will do or make their cause successful. That sounds like victory to me!

If we are going to win people, and change the culture we must have an attitude of victory. We have been defeated long enough! It is time we started walking in victory. Before we see the victory we must develop an attitude of victory!

May we be people who exemplify an attitude of victory!

Solomon made all these requests and did all this praying. What was God's response to Solomon's prayers? 2 Chronicles 7:14 (NKJV) ***"If My people who are called by My name will humble themselves, and pray and seek My face, and turn from their wicked ways, then I will hear from heaven, and will forgive their sin and heal their land."***

LIFE GROUP DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

READ 2 CHRONICLES 6

- 1) WHAT WAS SOLOMONS SIXTH ATTITUDE REQUEST? (Equality and diversity – Read 2 Chronicles 6:32-33)
- 2) WHAT SHOULD EQUALITY AND DIVERSITY LOOK LIKE IN OUR LIVES AND IN THE CHURCH? (The ground should be level, not just at the foot of the cross, but everywhere and with everyone we influence – Everyone's gifts and abilities should be celebrated – People go where

they are celebrated, not where they are tolerated)

- 3) WHAT KIND OF PERSON WOULD IT TAKE TO RUN YOU OUT OF this LIFE GROUP OR OUT OF THE CHURCH? (If we have an answer to that, we are not embracing the kind of equality and diversity God himself displays)
- 4) WHAT WAS SOLOMONS SEVENTH ATTITUDE REQUEST? (Victory – Read 2 Chronicles 2:34-35)
- 5) WHAT IS THE DEFINITION OF MAINTAINING THEIR CAUSE IN VS. 35? (Maintain means to do or to make – In other words when we embrace these attitudes God will do or make our lives successful)
- 6) WHAT WAS GOD'S RESPONSE TO SOLOMONS PRAYER? (Read 2 Chronicles 7:14 – Discuss how this Scripture can apply to our lives)